

IN TEST: 9 PERSONAL INFORMATION MANAGERS

A well-ordered life

Juggling and keeping track of your schedules, e-mails and appointments is a snap with personal information managers (PIMs)

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Think of it as a personal secretary. Only this one doesn't take long lunch breaks or keep pestering you for a raise. A personal information manager (PIM) lets you schedule appointments, remember birthdays, plan work-weeks, send e-mail and make phone calls—all from the same place.

A PIM is a small software that you can run on your system to enjoy the functionality of a daily planner, an address book, a calendar, an alarm clock, a phone diary, a fax machine and even an e-mail client!

We've put together nine PIMs available in the market to check which one can make life easiest for you.

TEST PROCESS

Features are the best indicators of how good a PIM is. So testing the PIMs largely involved searching for and scanning features that would help one maximise the benefits of information management. Besides features, the PIMs were also evaluated for ease of use. A very important aspect of this is integration. The PIM should be well integrated with the operating system, the e-mail client and phone dialler it uses, and also with other applications and handheld devices.

The aim of the PIM is to make life easier for a busy person, through uncluttered menus, intuitive icons and helpful documentation. So, PIMs